

# Building control approval application data June to August 2026

(all data as of 31 August 2026)

As in previous months, this Building Safety Regulator (BSR) dataset includes information relating to gateway 2 performance, with the London area performance separate.

We also include data on our internal and external resource usage and gateway 3 performance.

NHS applications are included as a separate category, with data on pages 4 and 9.

Detailed information on the number of major change requests and their processing times is on page 20. Timely resolution of these requests during construction is essential for work to continue.



## Recent trends

1. There has been an increase in gateway 2 applications. This could be because of the building safety levy, which comes into effect in October 2026. BSR has a mitigation plan in place and will continue to monitor the rate of new applications.
2. Our growing inspection programme has found a small number of examples where building work has not followed agreed designs and has required some remedial work. We will monitor this closely and take action where appropriate to help make sure that buildings are constructed in line with safe designs.



**New HRBs and conversions**

In progress

**147 ↗**

Units

**32,691 ↗**

Invalid or withdrawn

**5 ↘**

Decisions made

**50 ↗**

New in

**63 ↗**

Approval rate

**92% ↗**

Median approval time

**22 weeks →**

Units approved

**9,362 ↗**

**External remediation**

In progress

**327 ↘**

Units

**28,274 ↘**

Invalid or withdrawn

**20 ↗**

Decisions made

**118 ↗**

New in

**109 ↗**

Approval rate

**89% ↗**

Median approval time

**33 weeks ↘**

Units approved

**8,667 ↗**

**Headlines**

- August 2026 marks 12 months since the Innovation Unit was set up to deal exclusively with new build higher-risk building (HRB) applications.
- At that point, median approval time for new builds was at 43 weeks with an approval rate of 39%.
- Now, median approval time is 22 weeks with an approval rate of 92%.
- Over the same period, performance for external remediation applications improved significantly. Approval times fell from 43 weeks to 33 weeks, and approval rates increased from 47% to 89%.
- We've seen a steady increase in new build applications in August (34). We expect this number to increase in September, due to the introduction of the building safety levy on 1 October 2026.

**HRB internal works  
(category A and B)**

In progress  
**1,082 ↗**

Units  
**N/A**

Invalid or withdrawn  
**141 ↘**

Decisions made  
**143 ↘**

New in  
**457 ↗**

Approval rate  
**78% ↗**

Median approval time  
**32 weeks →**

Units approved  
**N/A**

**NHS internal works  
(category A and B)**

In progress  
**32 ↘**

Units  
**N/A**

Invalid or withdrawn  
**8 ↘**

Decisions made  
**22 ↗**

New in  
**30 ↗**

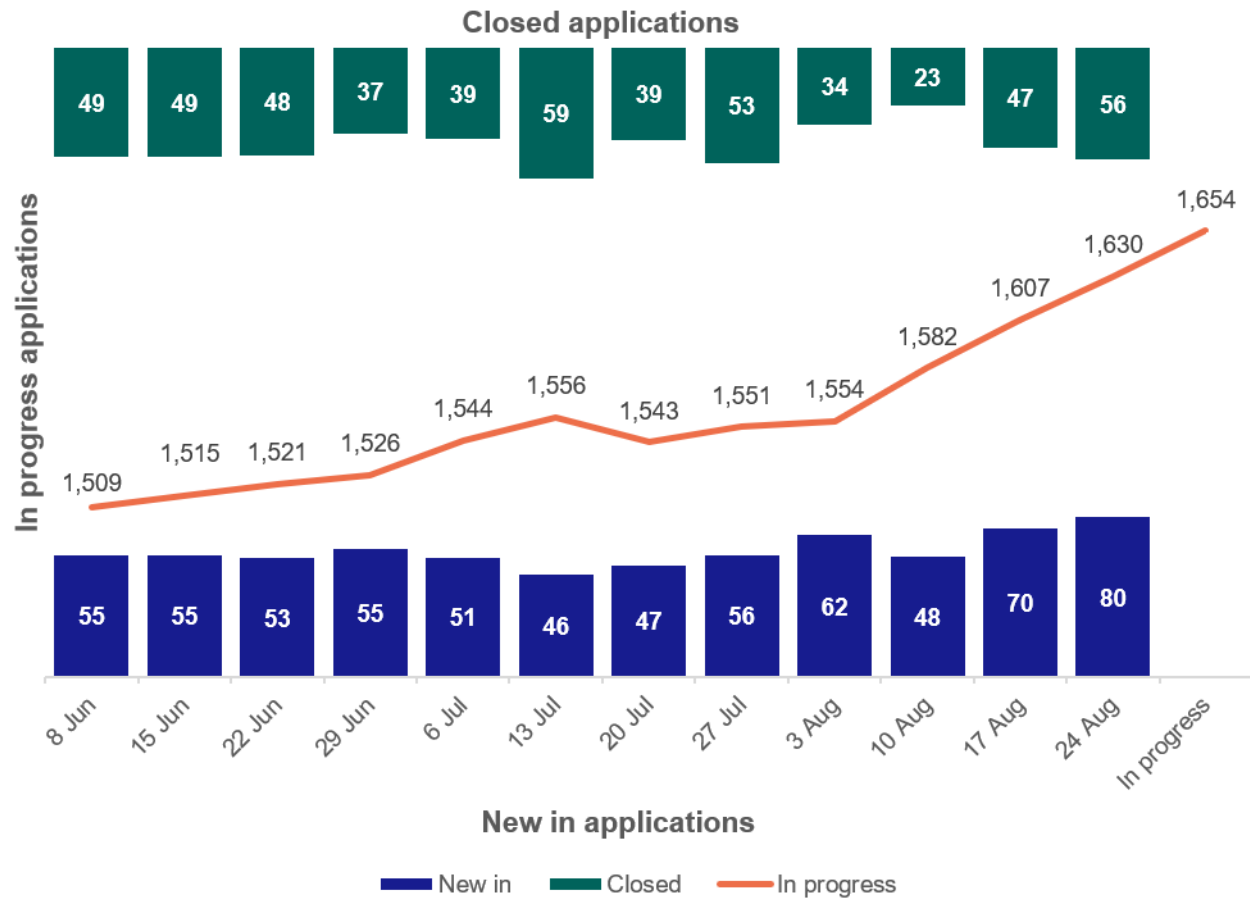
Approval rate  
**82% ↘**

Median approval time  
**22 weeks ↘**

Units approved  
**N/A7**

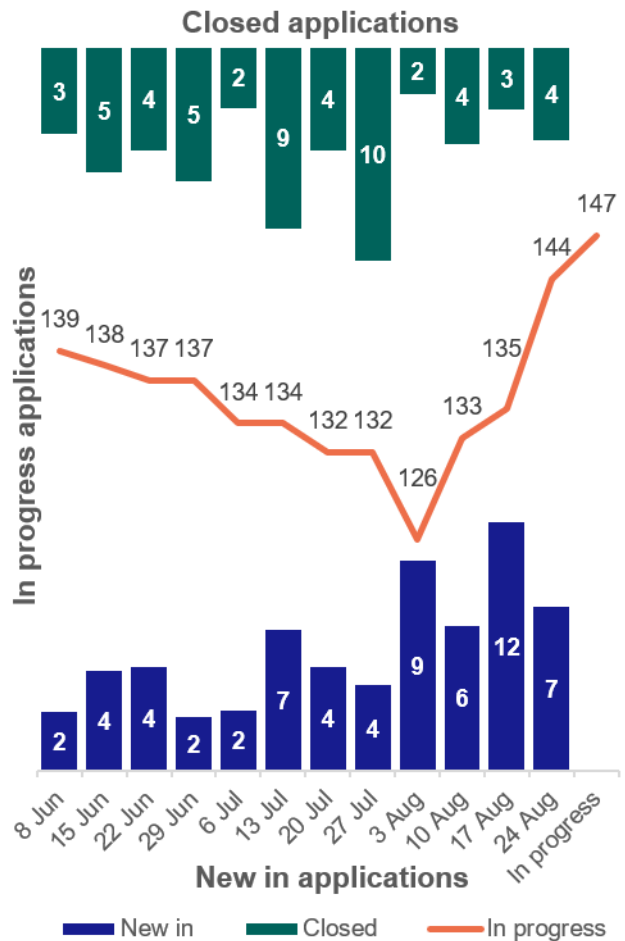
**Headlines**

- NHS applications continue as a separate category. They have previously been reported on within the HRB internal works dataset.
- These can include a range of building work in hospitals, from maintenance through to new hospital facilities.
- We have been working closely with the NHS to facilitate the specialist nature of their applications.
- This has started to show results, with some recent approvals coming in at the statutory 8-week timescale.
- The median approval time for NHS applications submitted in 2026 has reduced to 13 weeks.
- Showing a similar pattern, the median approval time for HRB internal works applications submitted in 2026 has reduced to 16 weeks.
- Overall median approval times are higher as we continue to close older applications from 2025.



## Commentary

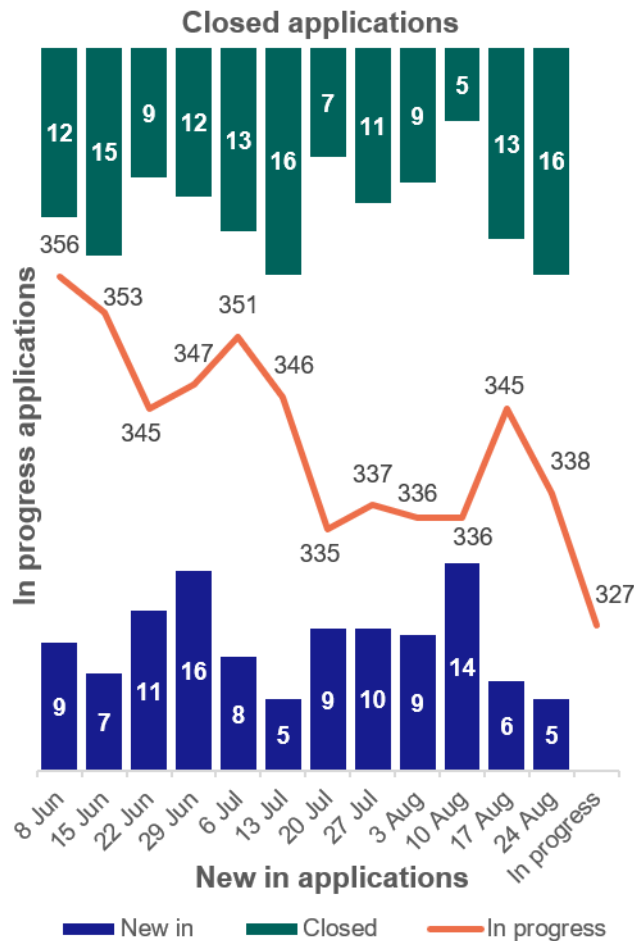
- There are currently 1,654 gateway 2 applications in progress. This is an increase of over 100 in August. BSR will monitor to see if whether this increase continues.
- These include the new build, external remediation, internal refurbishment and NHS applications which are explained in more detail on later pages.
- Transitional cases are also included. These are projects that revert to BSR when the building control body that was originally overseeing the project stops trading.
- Commenced under the previous building control regime, they are generally more complicated to progress. This is because much of the evidence that we now expect at gateway 2 is not available.
- There are currently 66 transitional cases in progress at gateway 2.



|                                 |                                    |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| New in<br>63                    | In progress<br>147                 |
| Decisions made<br>50            | Invalid / withdrawn<br>5           |
| Rejection % (#)<br>8% (4)       | Rejection weeks<br>8               |
| Approval % (#)<br>92% (46)      | Approval weeks<br>22               |
| In progress complex cases<br>33 | Complex cases approval weeks<br>33 |
| Units approved<br>9,362         | Units in progress<br>32,691        |

## Commentary

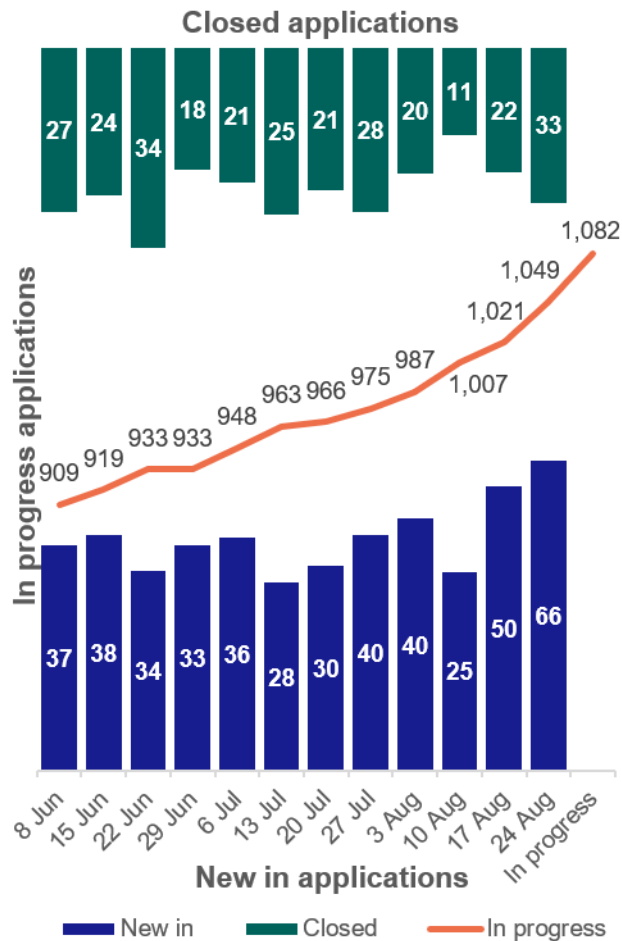
- Out of 63 applications received over the past 12 weeks, 4 applications were invalidated and 1 withdrawn. Of the 50 decisions made, 46 were approvals and 4 were rejections.
- This means that the 12-week rolling approval rate (not including invalidations and withdrawals) has risen to 92%, with the median approval time at 22 weeks.
- Complex cases are now tracked separately. While the final decision is included in the rejection or approval totals, their median approval time is now at 33 weeks.
- We continue to work closely with industry on a shared understanding of compliance as we try to reduce the number of complex cases in the system.
- The overall combined total is 147. This has increased over the past month from 131 at the end of July.



|                             |                             |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|
| New in<br>109               | In progress<br>327          |
| Decisions made<br>118       | Invalid / withdrawn<br>20   |
| Rejection % (#)<br>11% (13) | Rejection weeks<br>44       |
| Approval % (#)<br>89% (105) | Approval weeks<br>33        |
| Units approved<br>8,667     | Units in progress<br>28,274 |

## Commentary

- The rolling 12-week approval rate has increased this month to 89%, with the median approval time dropping to 33 weeks. This is a positive trend, but it remains above target due to the inclusion of older cases which have been in the system for some time.
- 12 legacy applications made in 2024 remain, down from 42 at the start of 2026.
- We also continue to work closely with the sector to help applicants improve the quality of applications.
- Data shows that applications submitted between October and December 2025 are moving faster through the system than earlier applications.
- The average approval time still appears high because it includes older applications from 2025 and 2025 that are still being cleared.
- 2026 approval rates already exceed the 75% target at 89%.

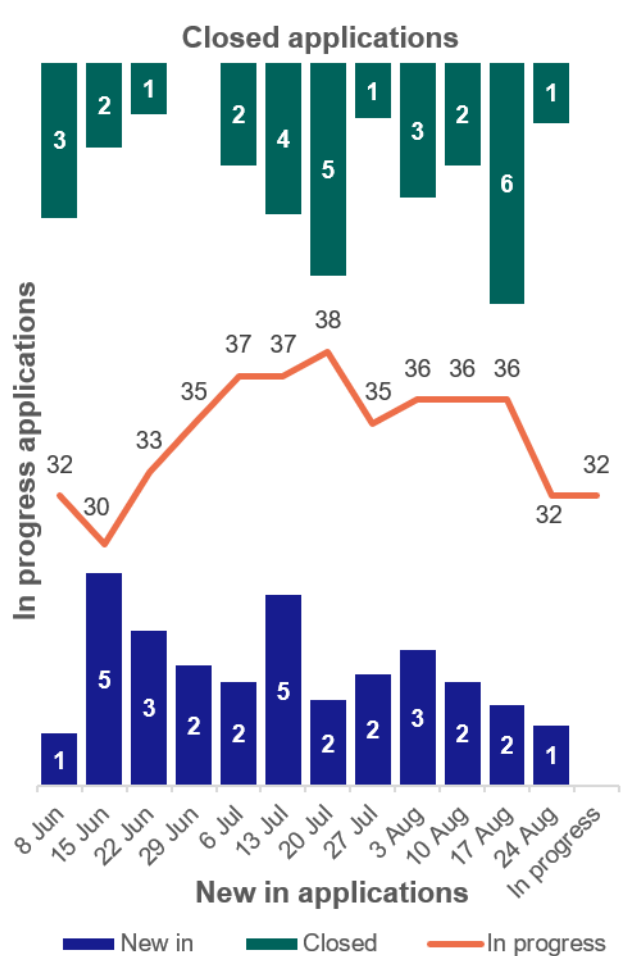


|                             |                            |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------|
| New in<br>457               | In progress<br>1,082       |
| Decisions made<br>143       | Invalid / withdrawn<br>141 |
| Rejection % (#)<br>22% (32) | Rejection weeks<br>24      |
| Approval % (#)<br>78% (111) | Approval weeks<br>32       |

## Commentary

- The approval rate for internal refurbishment works in category A and B is currently 78% with a median determination time for approvals of 32 weeks.
- New applications have been received at an average rate of 38 per week over the past 12 weeks. However, the weekly rate in August has been higher. We expect this increase to reduce as determination times reduce.
- The overall combined total is at an expected 1,082, having increased over the past 12 weeks.
- HRB internal work determinations over the past 12 weeks account for around 43% of all gateway 2 decisions. These applications include all internal refurbishment works except NHS applications.





|                                   |                                 |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| New in<br><b>30</b>               | In progress<br><b>32</b>        |
| Decisions made<br><b>22</b>       | Invalid / withdrawn<br><b>8</b> |
| Rejection % (#)<br><b>18% (4)</b> | Rejection weeks<br><b>15</b>    |
| Approval % (#)<br><b>82% (18)</b> | Approval weeks<br><b>22</b>     |

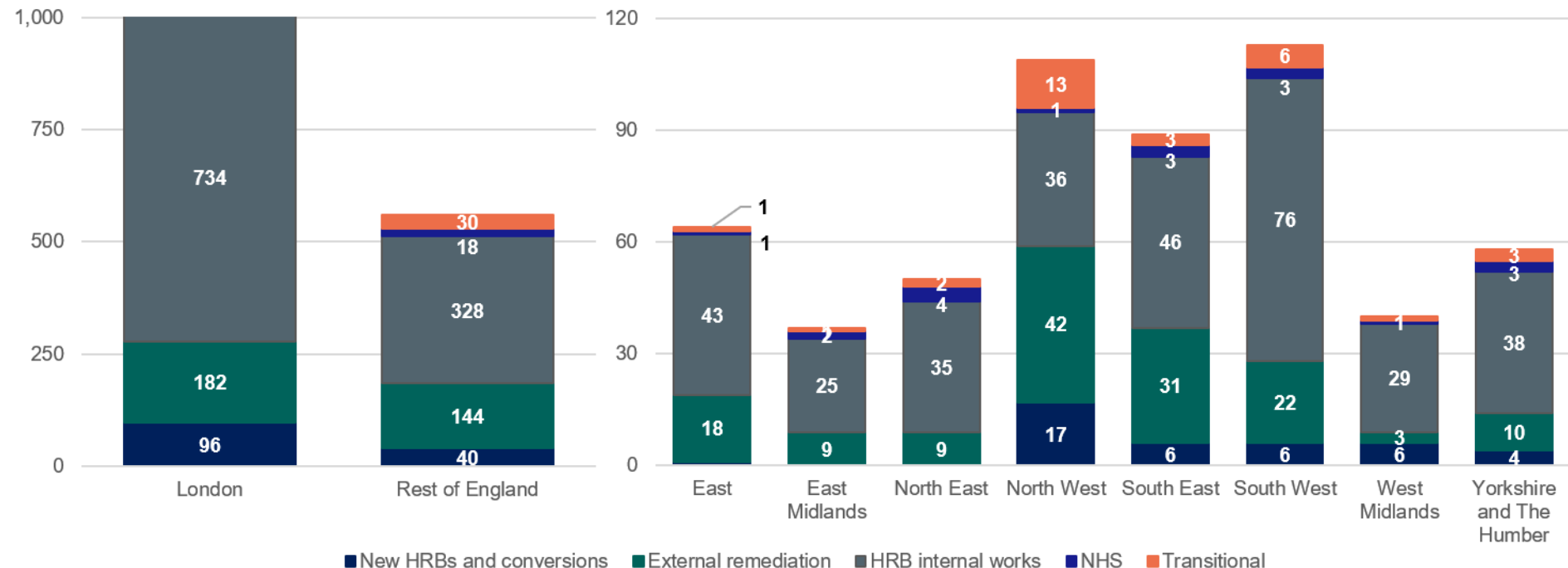
### Commentary

- NHS internal works are now been split from HRB internal works.
- The approval rate for NHS internal refurbishment is currently 82%.
- The median determination time for approvals is 22 weeks.
- New applications have been received at an average rate of 2 per week over the past 12 weeks.

# Regional distribution and London

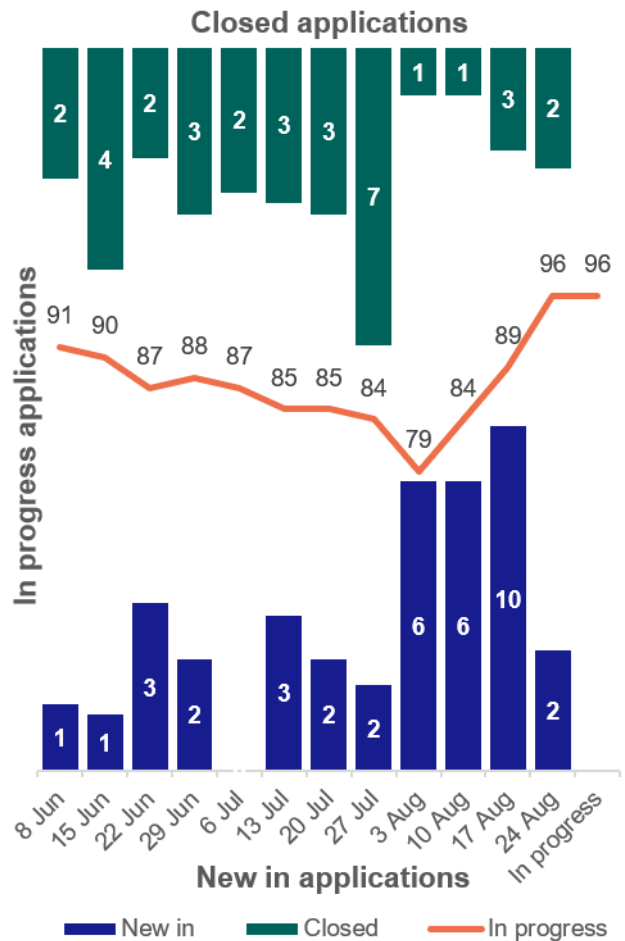
## Regional gateway 2 applications (London)

## Regional gateway 2 applications (Rest of England)



### Commentary

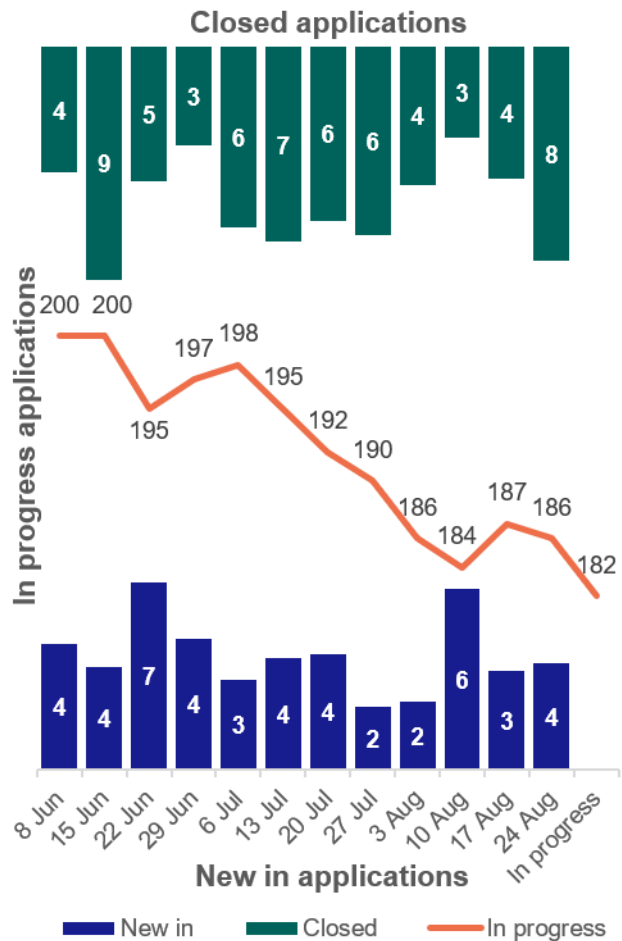
- Data as of the 31 August 2026.



|                                 |                                    |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| New in<br>38                    | In progress<br>96                  |
| Decisions made<br>31            | Invalid / withdrawn<br>2           |
| Rejection % (#)<br>10% (3)      | Rejection weeks<br>6               |
| Approval % (#)<br>90% (28)      | Approval weeks<br>23               |
| In progress complex cases<br>23 | Complex cases approval weeks<br>32 |
| Units approved<br>4,477         | Units in progress<br>20,046        |

Commentary

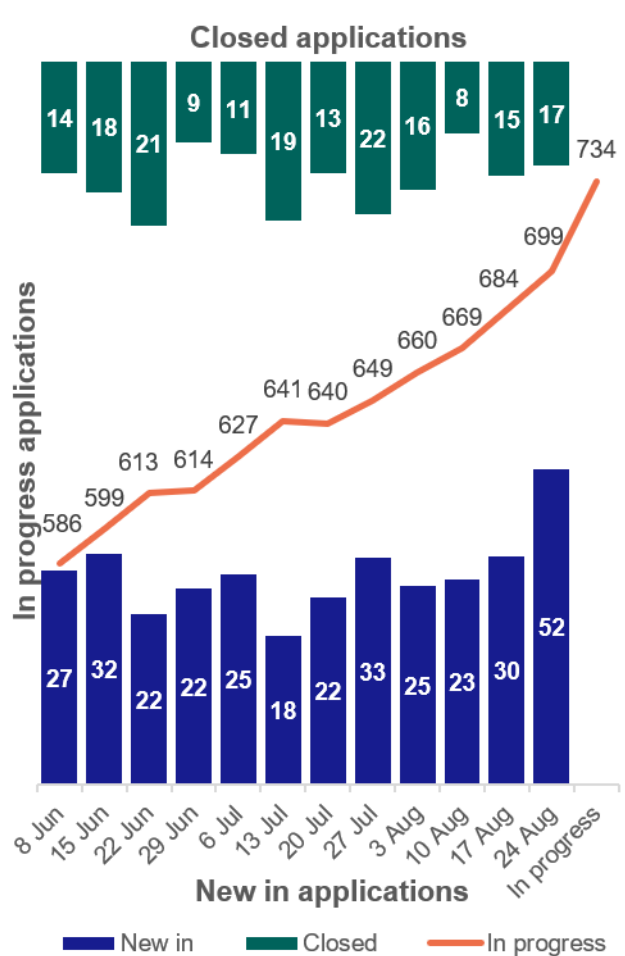
- Around 65% of in-progress new build applications are in London.
- This also represents around 61% of the overall new build residential units handled by BSR.
- 31 of the 50 new build decisions made in the last 12 weeks are in London.
- London approval rates are 90%. This figure shows significant work to resolve outstanding complex cases.
- Approval time for non-complex cases is 23 weeks, slightly above the national average.



|                            |                             |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------|
| New in<br>47               | In progress<br>182          |
| Decisions made<br>57       | Invalid / withdrawn<br>8    |
| Rejection % (#)<br>4% (2)  | Rejection weeks<br>18       |
| Approval % (#)<br>96% (55) | Approval weeks<br>32        |
| Units approved<br>3,936    | Units in progress<br>15,395 |

## Commentary

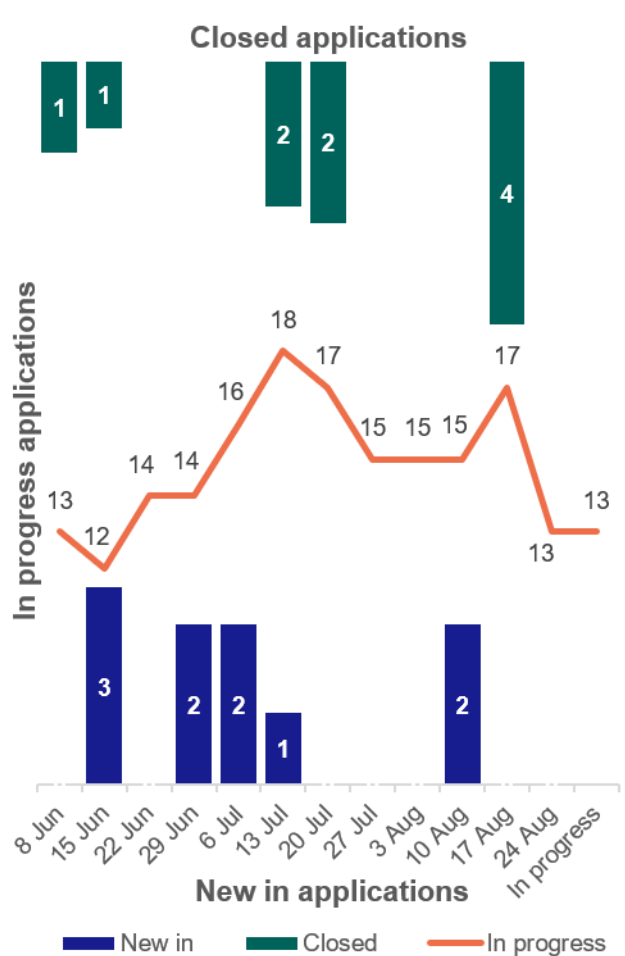
- Open remediation cases in London have dropped over the period from 200 to 182.
- Progress has been made since the announcement of the BSR remediation improvement plan in April 2026. There are now 12 legacy applications from 2024 remaining, down from 42 at the start of 2026.
- The median approval time in weeks based on the rolling total shows our effort to close older 2024 to 2025 applications, but these continue to affect the overall median approval times.
- Applications submitted in 2026 are being determined much more quickly.
- London approval rates of 96% are slightly higher than they are nationally.



|                             |                            |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------|
| New in<br>331               | In progress<br>734         |
| Decisions made<br>83        | Invalid / withdrawn<br>100 |
| Rejection % (#)<br>22% (18) | Rejection weeks<br>25      |
| Approval % (#)<br>78% (65)  | Approval weeks<br>32       |

## Commentary

- The approval rate for internal refurbishment works in category A and B is currently 78%, with a median determination time for approvals of 32 weeks. This is very similar to the national average.
- The overall combined total is less than the expected total of 850 to 900. It's currently 734, having increased over the past 12 weeks.
- HRB internal work determinations over the past 12 weeks account for around 46% of gateway 2 decisions. These applications include all internal refurbishment works, except NHS applications.



|                            |                          |
|----------------------------|--------------------------|
| New in<br>10               | In progress<br>13        |
| Decisions made<br>9        | Invalid / withdrawn<br>1 |
| Rejection % (#)<br>22% (2) | Rejection weeks<br>14    |
| Approval % (#)<br>78% (7)  | Approval weeks<br>33     |

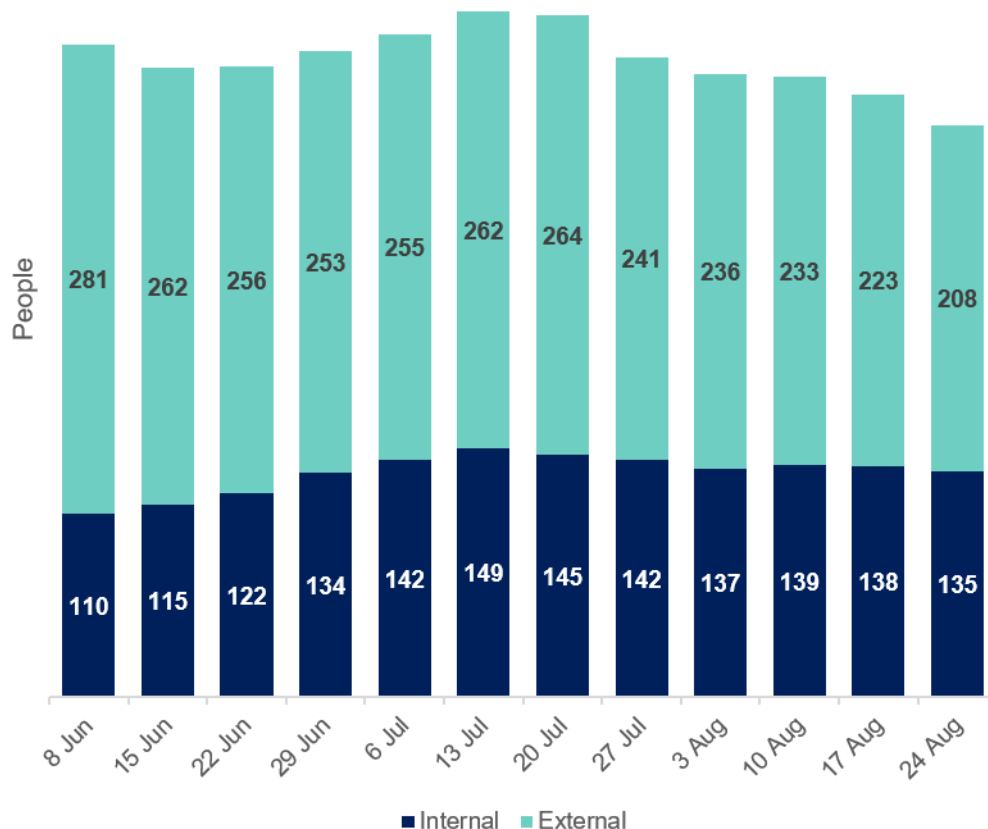
Commentary

- NHS internal works have now been split from HRB internal works
- The approval rate for NHS internal refurbishment works is currently 78%, with a median determination time for approvals of 33 weeks. This is slightly higher than the national average.

# Resourcing



## People working on Building Control applications



Sufficient internal, external and integrated resources are essential for BSR to meet demand. We have grown our internal regulatory team by 25 over the past 3 months, and we are continuing to actively recruit over the next 6 to 12 months. We are also growing our integrated resource teams to meet demand, see the 'Building control integrated resources' section.

### Internal resources

177 internal staff members have been or are currently involved:

- 101 regulatory leads
- 14 principal regulatory leads
- 58 case officers
- 4 case officer managers

### External resources

508 people from external organisations have been or are currently involved:

- 240 registered building inspectors (RBIs)
- 106 fire service professionals
- 127 structural engineers
- 35 specialist

### Integrated resources

Of the 508 people sourced or seconded from external organisations, 64 are integrated into BSR's Innovation Unit or external remediation teams:

- 36 RBIs
- 8 fire service professionals
- 20 structural engineers

BSR has several specialist resources working as part of an integrated workforce within the new build and external remediation teams. We are growing this capacity to meet demand and reduce processing times.

|                                          | Full-time equivalent as of 31 Jul (FTE) | Headcount as of 31 Jul | Forecast Aug (FTE) | Forecast Sep (FTE) | Forecast Oct (FTE) |
|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|------------------------|--------------------|--------------------|--------------------|
| Registered building inspectors           | 23.3                                    | 36                     | 25.3               | 29.3               | 34.3               |
| Structural engineers                     | 20                                      | 22                     | 20                 | 21                 | 25                 |
| Fire service professionals and engineers | 6.6                                     | 7                      | 6.6                | 6.6                | 11.6               |

\*Full-time equivalent (FTE) is an aggregated total of staff availability, as some people are available fewer than 5 days per week.

# In build: Change requests

### New HRBs and conversions

Live major change requests

**78 ↗**

New In

**99 ↗**

Closed

**77 ↗**

Median weeks to close

**7 ➡**

### External remediations

Live major change requests

**11 ↘**

New In

**15 ↘**

Closed

**24 ↘**

Median weeks to close

**10 ↘**

### HRB Internal works

Live major change requests

**67 ↗**

New In

**29 ↗**

Closed

**17 ↗**

Median weeks to close

**9 ↗**

### NHS applications

Live major change requests

**25 ↗**

New In

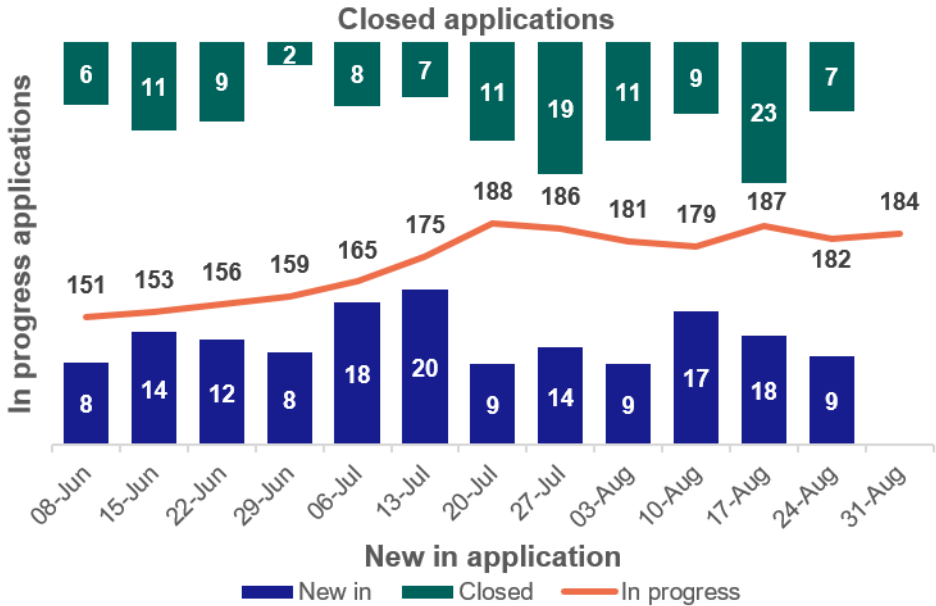
**11 ↗**

Closed

**1 ➡**

Median weeks to close

**20 ➡**



### Commentary

- BSR recognises that the timely processing of major change requests during build is vital to ensure construction can continue.
- There are currently 184 live major change requests. 123 requests have been closed in the period, including 119 shown in the data tables and 4 transitional requests.
- The median closure time for new build projects is currently at 7 weeks, just one week more than the statutory target.
- Transitional major change requests make up the remaining 3 of the 184 not shown on the data tables, with 2 new in and 4 closed.

# Gateway 3

## New HRBs and conversions

In progress

**0** ➔

Units

**0** ➔

Approvals

**0** ➔

New in

**0** ➔

## External remediation

In progress

**8** ↗

Units

**972** ↗

Approvals

**0**

New in

**3**

## HRB internal works

In progress

**105** ↗

Approvals

**9** ↘

New in

**45** ↗

## NHS internal works

In progress

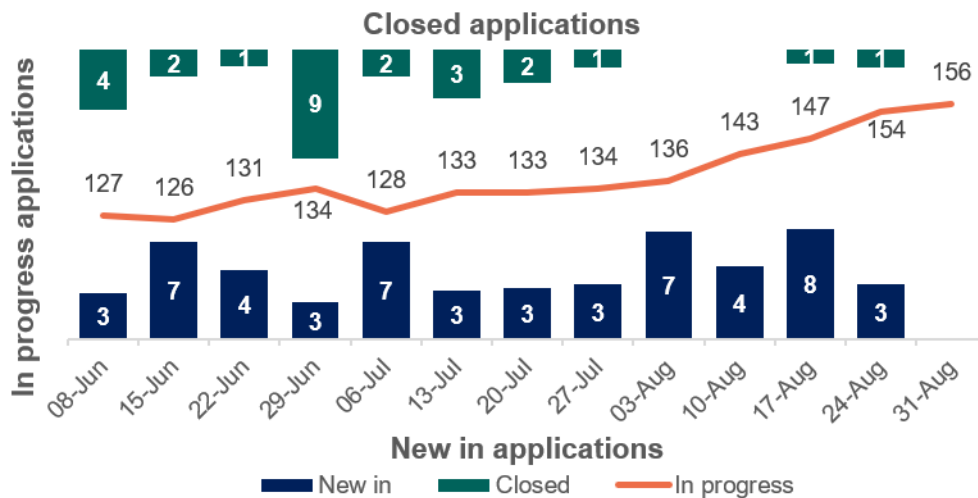
**15** ➔

Approvals

**4** ➔

New in

**5** ↘



## Commentary

- No new build projects that have passed through gateway 2 have reached gateway 3.
- Inspection regime for new build projects has highlighted a small amount of building work that deviates from designs agreed in gateway 2.
- Of the 346 gateway 3 applications received, 260 are internal refurbishments. Most of the remainder are transitional cases (45) and NHS internal refurbishments (23).
- Over the past 12 weeks, 16 gateway 3 applications have been determined with an approval rate of 88% and a median determination time of 20 weeks. The quickest determination was 7 weeks. This is an important area for BSR, particularly for new build projects, and we expect determination times to reduce as new processes are introduced and more resource is found.